Kitchen *& Kettle*

Beeswax Wraps at Home

A NATURAL, REUSABLE ALTERNATIVE TO PLASTIC WRAP.

Make your own in under an hour with three ingredients and an oven.

Free guide — no catch, just happy you're here.

What You're Making

Beeswax wraps are pieces of cotton fabric infused with beeswax, pine resin, and jojoba oil. They replace plastic wrap for covering bowls, wrapping cheese, folding around sandwiches, and sealing cut produce. They're washable, reusable for up to a year, and compostable at the end of their life.

The pine resin gives the wrap its cling — without it, you've just got a waxy piece of cloth that doesn't stick to anything. The jojoba oil keeps the wrap flexible instead of brittle. Together, the three ingredients make a wrap that molds to bowls and holds its shape with the warmth of your hands.

What You Need

- **100% cotton fabric.** Lightweight, tightly woven — quilting cotton works best. Cut into squares: 8×8 inches for small bowls, 12×12 for medium, 14×14 for large. Old cotton sheets or shirts work fine too.
- **Beeswax.** Food-grade pellets or a block you can grate. About 2 tablespoons per 12×12 wrap.
- **Pine resin.** Food-grade, powdered. This is what makes the wrap cling. Available online or at natural food stores. About 1 tablespoon per 12×12 wrap.
- **Jojoba oil.** A teaspoon or two per wrap. Keeps the wax from cracking. Don't substitute — most other oils go rancid over time.
- **An old baking sheet** you don't mind dedicating to this. Line it with parchment paper.
- **An oven.** Set to 200°F — the lowest most ovens go.
- **A paintbrush** you'll never use for painting again.

> *Buy a beeswax wrap starter kit if you don't want to source everything separately. They come with pre-measured pellets and instructions. This guide is for making them from scratch with bulk ingredients — cheaper per wrap if you plan to make more than a few.*

How to Make Them

> *Oven method — the simplest way. Takes about 20 minutes of active time, plus cooling.*

1. Prep the fabric

- Wash and dry the cotton fabric first — it'll shrink slightly, and you want that to happen before the wax goes on.
- Cut into squares with pinking shears if you have them. The zigzag edge reduces fraying. Regular scissors work fine — just accept a few loose threads at the edges.

2. Set up your pan

- Line an old baking sheet with parchment paper. Don't skip this — wax will melt through to the pan.
- Lay the fabric flat on the parchment. Smooth out any wrinkles.
- Sprinkle beeswax pellets and pine resin powder evenly across the fabric. Drizzle a few drops of jojoba oil over the top.

3. Melt in the oven

- Place the pan in a 200°F oven. Check every 5 minutes — the wax melts in 10–15 minutes depending on your oven and the size of the fabric.
- When the ingredients are fully melted and the fabric looks wet and saturated, pull the pan out.

4. Spread and set

- Use the paintbrush to spread any unmelted bits and even out the wax coating. Work quickly — it starts setting in under a minute.
- Lift the fabric off the parchment with tongs or fingers (careful — it's hot) and wave it gently in the air for 10–15 seconds. It'll cool and stiffen almost immediately.
- Lay it flat on a drying rack or hang it with a clothespin. It's ready to use in about 5 minutes.

That's it. One pan, one oven, one batch. Make a few extras while you're set up — the process is the same whether you're making one wrap or six.

Using and Caring for Your Wraps

- **To use:** Warm the wrap with your hands for a few seconds — body heat softens the wax enough to mold around a bowl or fold over food. Press gently along the edges to seal.
- **To wash:** Rinse with cool water and a drop of mild soap. Hot water melts the wax right off. Scrub gently — the coating is durable but not indestructible. Air dry. Don't wring or twist.
- **To store:** Fold and keep in a drawer or basket. They don't need anything special. Don't store in direct sunlight or near the stove — heat is the enemy.
- **Lifespan:** About 6–12 months with regular use. When the wrap loses its cling or looks thin and cracked, it's done. Compost the cotton, or re-coat it with fresh wax and keep going.

What Beeswax Wraps Won't Do

HONEST NOTE

Beeswax wraps are not for raw meat or fish — anything that needs a full wash in hot water is a no-go, because hot water strips the wax. They won't seal as tightly as plastic wrap, so don't expect an airtight seal on a bowl of soup. They're great for covering proofing dough, wrapping hard cheese, sealing half an avocado, bundling fresh herbs, and covering a salad bowl for a few hours. For wet foods and long-term fridge storage, glass containers with lids still win.

> *Re-coating old wraps: if the wax coating looks thin but the fabric is still sound, sprinkle a little fresh beeswax on top and pop it back in the oven for 5 minutes. The old wax blends with the new. One bag of pellets can keep your wraps going for years.*

Make a few, use them well

One batch, one afternoon, one less roll of plastic in the landfill. These wraps won't change your life. But they'll change your kitchen — a little quieter, a little less disposable, a little closer to the way things used to be made.

Works because it works.

Kitchen & Kettle

A quieter way to run a kitchen.